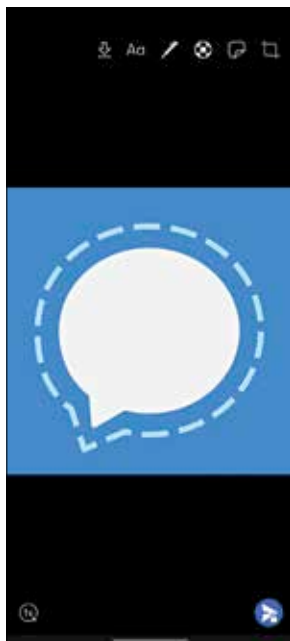


Recents menu, which is great. To enable this feature, tap your profile icon on the top left corner of the Signal home screen, and then click on Privacy. Here, you simply need to toggle on 'Screen Security' and that's it.

SEND ONE-TIME VIEWABLE IMAGES

Signal has baked in another great trick into its interface where it allows you to send images that can be



Click on the infinity sign on the bottom left to enable 1x viewable images

viewed only once. After the image has been viewed by the recipient, it will simply cease to exist on both ends. One time viewable images cannot be saved to a device's storage, therefore, this feature becomes even more secure. To do this, click an image on the Signal camera or select one from your gallery. Now, in the image sending screen, locate the 'infinity icon' in the bottom left corner of the screen and click it once. It should change to '1x'. This means the recipient can only

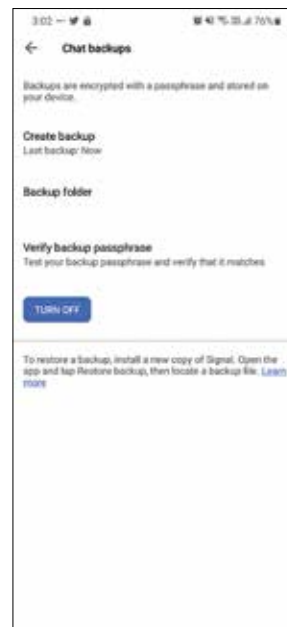
view the image once and cannot save it to their device storage. Once the image has been opened, it cannot be viewed again.

RELAY CALLS

This is one of Signal's most coveted features, especially for users who want maximum security for their private calls. The feature allows you to transmit all your calls through the Signal server, therefore, your IP address will not be revealed to any of your contacts. If they try to check, they will just be able to view Signal's IP address which is protecting your identity. You can enable this by heading over to Signal's Privacy menu and selecting 'Always relay calls' under the Communication tab. However, there's one serious drawback. Enabling relay calls will slightly reduce the call quality due to network tunnelling. However, if you're more concerned about the security of your IP address, then this is the way to go.

BACKUP YOUR CHATS AND MEDIA

By default, Signal doesn't create a local or cloud backup of your chats and media for security reasons. However, you can activate backups on Signal, should you want to. To do this, open Settings on Signal and tap on 'Chats and Media'. Now, under the Backup tab, click on 'Chat backups' and then click 'Turn on'. You will be given a passphrase by Signal for the backup you are about to create so ensure to note it down since you will need eventually, when you want to restore your saved backup. Once you have noted down the passphrase or code, click



Enable backups for your Signal chats and media

'Enable Backups'. To restore the backup on say a new phone, open the app and tap 'Restore Backup' in the same menu, and then locate your backup file to restore it.

INCOGNITO KEYBOARD

If you want your keyboard to not learn from your typing behaviour and personalise itself accordingly when you're using Signal, you can turn on the Incognito Keyboard. If you activate this setting, none of your typing and clipboard data will be recorded by the keyboard you're using. To enable this, head over to Settings > Privacy. Now, enable Incognito Keyboard and you're done.

USE IT AS A QUICK PHOTO EDITOR

Signal's inbuilt photo editor is a pretty nifty one that can be used to add text, highlight parts of the image in different colours with a pen tool, crop the image, add stickers, and more. You can even save the image to the gallery once you have edited

it on Signal. There's also the fairly new blur tool which allows you to blur faces in photos, or even blur other parts of a photo, such as names and phone numbers in screenshots. While you cannot add filters or mess around with the exposure via this editor, it is still pretty useful to make small edits quickly within the app.

STOP DESCRIPTIVE NOTIFICATIONS

By default, Signal, much like other messaging apps, will display a contact's name and message when they text you. But you can actually turn this off and only have the app notify you that there's a new message without displaying the name and text. To enable this, head over to Settings



Hide your messages from prying eyes in the notification bar

> Notifications. Now, under the Messages tab, find 'Show' and then select the option you desire. You can choose to have Signal display no name and no message, just the name, or both in the notification bar. 